FIRED FLOCK SAFETY WORKER SUES, SAYS AUSTIN FIRM RAN A SEXIST BOYS CLUB

By Sophie Leclerc

Published on October 20, 2026



A former account manager at Flock Safety sued the surveillance technology company in federal court in Austin on Monday, alleging she was scrutinized more harshly than her male colleagues, pushed into an unfair travel assignment, and ultimately fired after she complained. Megan Deterling, who worked as a major accounts manager at the company starting in January 2024, says she endured a sexist “boys club” culture before Flock terminated her in July 2025.

Allegations of Unequal Treatment and a Punishing Reassignment

According to the lawsuit, as reported by Law360, Deterling received fewer and lower-quality accounts than her male peers and says managers ridiculed and demeaned her during team meetings. Per the Austin

American-Statesman, she alleges she was reassigned to handle accounts outside her home state, requiring extensive travel, and was told she was the only Flock employee forced to work that way. The lawsuit says multiple peers reached out to Deterling about the reassignment, with one warning her she now had a target on her back.

Deterling began raising internal complaints in January 2025, according to the Statesman's report, and says she was promised that accounts would be redistributed more fairly that year. Instead, she says a manager berated and insulted her about her performance even though she was outperforming many of her peers. She says her supervisors failed to address her concerns and retaliated against her instead — and alleges Flock was trying to make her quit.

Investigation Closed Within Weeks, Then a Firing

The lawsuit says Flock closed an investigation into Deterling's formal human resources complaint just weeks after it began, finding no harassment or discrimination, according to her account. She was fired in July 2025. Deterling is now suing for retaliation and discrimination, seeking lost wages and benefits, front pay or reinstatement, compensatory and punitive damages, attorneys' and expert fees, costs and interest, per the Statesman's reporting.

A Flock spokesperson said the company is confident in its position and intends to vigorously defend against the allegations, according to the Statesman. The lawsuit accuses Flock Safety of discriminating against a female employee and retaliating against her for raising concerns, though the underlying allegations

remain claims made in litigation rather than findings established in court.

A Company Already Under Pressure

The lawsuit lands as Flock Safety faces fallout over revelations of abuses involving its technology, which has installed thousands of internet-connected public license plate-reading cameras across the country. Press reports have documented officers abusing the system to monitor personal connections and stalk former lovers. Some Texas cities have barred use of Flock cameras and ended their contracts altogether, part of a broader reckoning for the Atlanta-based company.

That reckoning has hit Flock's finances and workforce too. Wired reported that Flock's downturn led the company to roll out a voluntary employee separation program last month, giving its roughly 1,500 workers until Oct. 2 to decide whether to accept severance and leave. The offer came even though Flock had raised money in April at a valuation north of $8 billion, the outlet noted. Flock CEO Garrett Langley has said the backlash's “biggest damage” has been to internal morale, the same report added.

Flock keeps bleeding municipal customers as it tries to weather the controversy. The same Wired report found that an advocacy group identified 93 city and county governments that cut ties with Flock in August alone, and that roughly three times as many local governments dropped the company in 2026 as in the previous five years combined.

Texas Cities Keep Pulling the Plug

Texas has become a flashpoint in that pushback. The Houston Chronicle found that two dozen Texas cities and counties have taken steps to remove Flock's

automated license plate readers or end their contracts with the company. Austin's own police department discontinued its automated license plate reader policy in July 2025 after ending its Flock pilot program, saying it had no plans to negotiate a new contract.

Other Texas communities followed. The Bandera City Council voted 3-2 in May to terminate its Flock contract, remove existing equipment and halt new camera installations, the Chronicle reported. Bastrop's city council voted unanimously on Sept. 8 to decommission its system after ordering its 12 cameras covered, while Leander's police department stopped using Flock cameras and data as of Sept. 4. Pflugerville ended its contract in August and covered all its cameras, and Dallas has moved to shut down 321 state-funded readers while keeping roughly 300 city-funded cameras running. TechCrunch has reported that numerous state and local governments, including in Florida and Texas, have said they will stop using the technology altogether.

Flock also faces a separate federal class action in Colorado, where plaintiff Chrisanna Elser alleges Flock footage contributed to her being wrongly prosecuted for a crime she did not commit, according to Courthouse News. A Flock spokesperson told the outlet the company would defend itself in court and attributed Elser's incident to human error.

Austin - **Politics & Govt**

Trending in Austin

About 11 hours ago

East Austin Food Truck Owner Badly Burned in Generator Blast, Fights to Reopen

About 13 hours ago

Six Women Rescued in Bexar County Trafficking Raids on Massage Businesses

About 13 hours ago

Round Rock Opens Wyoming Springs Drive Extension, New I-35 Escape Route

About 14 hours ago

Texas Hides Which Schools Cash In on $1 Billion Voucher Program

Load More

NATIONAL



Hoodline - In-depth reporting about your home area.

Follow Us

contact@hoodline.com

Connect

- Subscribe
- Follow on Twitter
- Like on Facebook
- Network on Linkedin
- Inspire on Instagram
- Contact Us

But wait, there's more...

- Submit a Tip
- Careers
- Advertising
- Privacy Policy
- Terms of Service
- Disclaimer / Use of AI

Cities

SOUTH BAY SAN JOSE SAN FRANCISCO OAKLAND
NORTH SF BAY AREA DALY CITY BAY AREA ALAMO SQUARE
ATLANTA AUSTIN BALTIMORE BOSTON BRONX BROOKLYN
CASTRO CHARLOTTE CHICAGO CINCINNATI CIVIC CENTER
CLEVELAND COLUMBUS COW HOLLOW DALLAS DENVER
DETROIT DIVISADERO DOWNTOWN LA DUBOCE TRIANGLE
DURHAM EAST LOS ANGELES EL PASO EMBARCADERO FILLMORE
FINANCIAL DISTRICT FISHERMAN'S WHARF GOLDEN GATE PARK
HAYES VALLEY HOLLYWOOD HONOLULU HOUSTON INDIANAPOLIS
JAPANTOWN KNOXVILLE LAS VEGAS LAUREL HEIGHTS
LOS ANGELES LOWER HAIGHT MANHATTAN MARINA MEMPHIS
MIAMI MID-MARKET MILWAUKEE MINNEAPOLIS MISSION
NASHVILLE NEW ORLEANS NEW YORK CITY NOE VALLEY
NORTH BEACH OKLAHOMA CITY ORLANDO PACIFIC HEIGHTS
PHILADELPHIA PHOENIX PITTSBURGH POLK PORTLAND
POTRERO HILL QUEENS RALEIGH RALEIGH-DURHAM
RUSSIAN HILL SACRAMENTO SALT LAKE CITY SAN ANTONIO
SAN DIEGO SAN FERNANDO VALLEY SEATTLE SOMA
SOUTH LOS ANGELES STATEN ISLAND TAMPA TENDERLOIN
TWIN PEAKS UNION SQUARE UPPER HAIGHT WASHINGTON, D.C.
WEST LOS ANGELES

© 2026 SFist LLC